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Protocol

CustomStringConvertible

A type with a customized textual representation.

iOS 8.0+ | iPadOS 8.0+ | Mac Catalyst 13.0+ | macOS 10.10+ | tvOS 9.0+ |
visionOS 1.0+ | watchOS 2.0+

```
protocol CustomStringConvertible
```

Overview

Types that conform to the `CustomStringConvertible` protocol can provide their own representation to be used when converting an instance to a string. The `String(describing:)` initializer is the preferred way to convert an instance of *any* type to a string. If the passed instance conforms to `CustomStringConvertible`, the `String(describing:)` initializer and the `print(_:)` function use the instance’s custom description property.

Accessing a type’s `description` property directly or using `CustomStringConvertible` as a generic constraint is discouraged.

Conforming to the CustomStringConvertible Protocol

Add `CustomStringConvertible` conformance to your custom types by defining a `description` property.

For example, this custom `Point` struct uses the default representation supplied by the standard library:

```
struct Point {
```